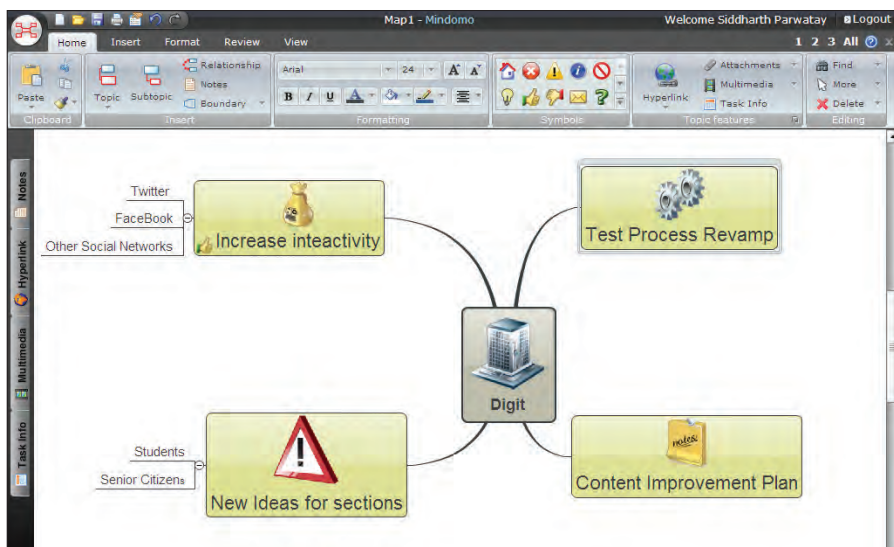


Cheaper iBooks?

Apple's eBooks apparently cheaper than initially thought

Meridian F 80

The exotic and compact speakers are available in India for approximately Rs. 2,00,000



Mindmap in mindomo

you! Using technology, you can... There are several sticky notes applications that you can download which let you pepper your desktop with multi-coloured digital post-its. Hence they remain in-your-face all the time, helping you remember important tasks, messages, ideas, appointments, phone numbers, birthdays etc.

One such application is StickyNotes 2.2 and can be downloaded from www.igorv.com. It allows you to turn a sticky into an alarm as well. If you're running Windows 7, you should know that it comes with its own stickies app inbuilt. Rememberthemilk.com is an online version of the to-do list, which sends you reminders before the task is due. Todoist.com features a Firefox sidebar and iGoogle integration. Vitalist.com is another similar alternative. Another simple service is sticky-screen.org. The site requires no login, and doesn't make you download anything. It works on cookies, and as long as you don't delete the cookie, you can access anything you typed into the solitary sticky note you are provided with.

Mind map yourself

Mind mapping is the technique by which ideas and relationships amongst the various elements surrounding a topic are represented graphically. It's usually easier to remember pictures than text, so this helps you remember stuff better, and also think things through in an orderly fashion, whilst being aware of all your thoughts on

the topic. Apart from work, this also applies to the way you study, as you can now dissect topics with ease, and learn anything that has points to remember.

There are several mind mapping tools out there that let you collaborate on the thought flow. But since simplicity is one of the intrinsic factors of mind mapping, these tools have to be easy to use too. Mindmeister (www.mindmeister.com) is an interesting tool but requires you to sign up, whilst bubbl.us lets you get to work right away. A more visually appealing tool was mindomo.com. It features curved lines, shaded boxes and many more added utilities, symbols and formatting.

De-stress

Whether you're cramming for an exam, or working on a tight deadline, there's



Students such as Shrey use web sites in their friend circle to share notes

nothing worse than a tired mind. Various comprehensive studies have shown that a stressed and tired mind is less accepting of new information, and is also slower at recalling learned knowledge. Now we're not suggesting you give up and go to sleep, just because your brain is tired. Instead, we're suggesting that you recharge your mind with a little entertainment, or relaxation.

A simple freeware timer application such as Minute Timer 1.1 will suffice in most cases. It'll pop up at the specified time and all you need to do is stretch a leg or play a quick game of minesweeper or solitaire. A more comprehensive tool is WorkSmart which can be downloaded from installand-enjoy.com. The application lets you configure your work timings and set multiple breaks for the day. Of course, for workaholics and studious kids, we have to bring out the big guns. Workrave is an application that is actually designed to assist in the recovery and prevention of Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI). It is coercive and forces you to take small breaks by locking down your system for a certain amount of time.

Now let's look at some other ways in which technology can help you extend your capabilities, depending on whether you're a student or a working professional.

Students

We spoke to a lot of students as research for this article, to try and figure out what it is students are doing differently these days, if anything. Based on their feedback, we got a few tips, and when we found problems, we looked for viable solutions

Problem: Sifting through the web

Solution: A lot of students seemed to have trouble finding sites that catered to their specific stream or exam board. It's obvious that ICSE students would not like to solve CBSE mock exams, and vice versa. That's where sites like Planettutor.in come in. Planettutor has products from Class 9 up to engineering. Another interesting service from them is Enggmth.com, which caters to students facing difficulties in maths at the engineering level. The syllabi as well as solved question papers for math at this level are available